

INITIAL LANGUAGE EVALUATION REPORT

Cyril BLANCHOT

Candidate: Cyril BLANCHOT
Job Title: Associé — Cabinet Cyril BLANCHOT
Interview Date: 29 June 2026
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Final Evaluation Report — Legal English Needs Analysis

Profile: Avocat

Interviewer: Joss Frimond, Linguaid France

Professional Context

Cyril BLANCHOT is a partner and sole practitioner at his own firm, specialising in **business law and M&A**. Although English currently represents approximately **10% of his professional activity**, this figure is growing. He has handled at least one significant cross-border matter in the past year and is currently working on a **joint venture file with an English-language dimension**, primarily written at this stage.

Cyril is strategic about his career trajectory. At 42, he runs his practice independently but does not exclude the possibility of joining a larger firm in the future — an environment in which **full professional command of English would become a core requirement**. His motivation is therefore both immediate and forward-looking, though he approaches the process without urgency.

Needs Identified

Based on the needs-analysis interview, Cyril's primary English usage in practice centres on the following professional situations:

- **Solo client calls** — handling negotiations and client dialogue without support
- **Client meetings and video conferences** — including multi-party discussions in an M&A context
- **Presentations** — structuring and delivering legal positions clearly and convincingly in English

His written skills — reading and drafting — have been actively developed through recent casework and are notably stronger. The priority need is therefore **spoken communication**: the ability to interact fluently, accurately, and with authority in live professional situations.

Current Level & Key Gaps

Cyril's approximate level, assessed through interview, is **B1+**.

His receptive skills are relatively solid — he reports understanding approximately 90% of spoken content in professional exchanges, including domain-specific legal vocabulary. His difficulties are concentrated in **active, spontaneous spoken production**.

Key gaps identified are as follows:

- **Spoken fluency and spontaneity** — Cyril reports mentally translating from French before speaking, which creates hesitation and slows his responses in real-time exchanges
- **Confidence in spoken interaction** — despite understanding the conversation and knowing the subject matter, he experiences anxiety around making basic grammatical errors, which inhibits his participation
- **Active oral participation** — two recent video conferences highlighted this gap directly; he understood the content but held back from contributing as fully as he would in French
- **Oral accuracy under pressure** — the gap between his passive comprehension and his active spoken output is the defining challenge to address

His written English (reading and drafting of legal documents) is a relative strength and requires less immediate attention.

Learning Objectives

By the end of the programme, Cyril should be able to:

- **Conduct client calls and video conferences independently and confidently** in English, without relying on mental translation as a primary processing strategy
- **Participate actively in multi-party meetings**, including M&A and joint venture discussions, with appropriate legal register and vocabulary
- **Structure and deliver clear oral presentations** of legal positions, due diligence findings, and deal terms to English-speaking counterparts

- **Manage interaction dynamically** — asking for clarification, buying processing time, and holding the floor with professional ease
- **Reduce performance anxiety** by building strong spoken habits through repeated, contextualised legal practice

Recommendation

Parameter	Detail
Recommended Programme	CAJA (Coaching Anglais Juridique Avancé)
Target Level	C1
Recommended Hours	20 hours
Proposed Start Date	29 June 2026
Financing	CPF

The **CAJA programme** is recommended as it is specifically designed for legal professionals operating at an intermediate-advanced level who need to close the gap between strong passive competence and confident active production. The focus on **spoken legal English in realistic professional scenarios** — calls, negotiations, meetings, and presentations — directly addresses Cyril's identified needs.

Given that his written skills are already functional and that his current joint venture file provides a live working context, coaching sessions should draw on **real materials and situations from his practice** wherever possible. This will maximise relevance, efficiency, and engagement.

Twenty hours is considered appropriate to achieve meaningful, durable progress toward C1 oral performance, in line with Cyril's professional ambitions.

Sign-off

This report reflects the findings of a qualitative needs-analysis interview and does not constitute a formal CEFR-certified language assessment. Level indications are approximate and intended to guide programme design.

Prepared by: Joss Frimond

Organisation: Linguaid France